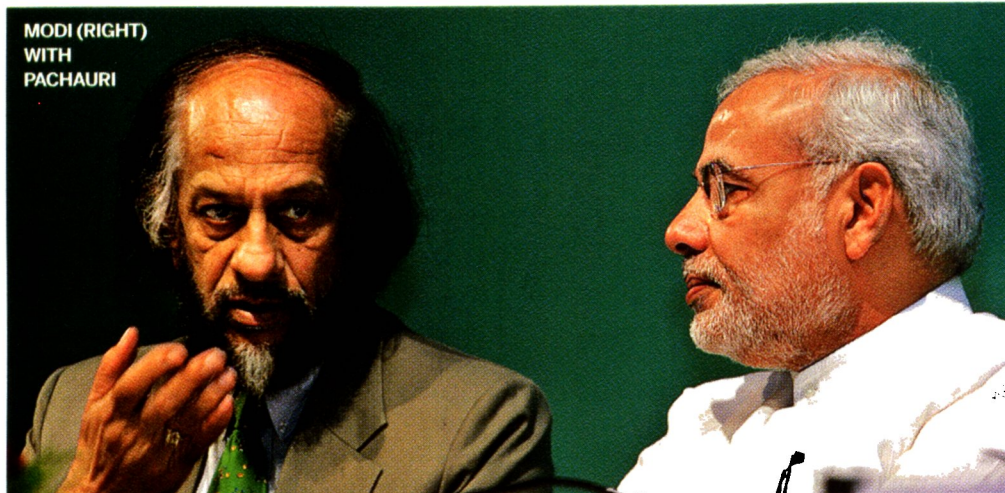


AHMEDABAD | Warming up to Change



Gujarat is the first state that has realised the implications of global warming with Chief Minister Narendra Modi floating a new ministerial portfolio for climate change. It is a portfolio that does not exist even in the Union Government yet. The initiative follows Modi's recent interaction with scientist Dr R.K. Pachauri, member of Al Gore's team which bagged the Nobel Prize for its work on global warming.

Modi's decision to float a separate climate change minister is also influenced by a Labour Party member of British Parliament, Barry Gardiner, British Prime Minister Gordon Brown's special envoy to the United Nations on climate change. Gujarat also leads in carbon credits in the country and has been working decisively to save its forests and increase tree cover.

by Uday Mahurkar

Star Struck

With the Lok Sabha election dates announced, the BJP is wooing Bollywood stars Anil Kapoor and Anupam Kher and supercop Kiran Bedi to contest polls and draw crowds and votes.

BANGALORE | Patriotic Hardsell



THE UNNIKRISHNANS WITH ADVANI (RIGHT)

The Karnataka BJP Government's war cry against terror has brought the family of Major Sandeep Unnikrishnan—who died in Mumbai's 26/11 terror attacks—closer to the party. At a recent event to honour Major Unnikrishnan hosted by BJP prime ministerial candidate L.K. Advani, the late commando's father K. Unnikrishnan said, "Me and my wife are ready to die. Let them (terrorists) kill us," he said. Publicity of this kind is more than welcome for the BJP before the elections. Chief Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa went a step further by announcing that a road in Yelahanka satellite township will be named after Major Unnikrishnan.

by Stephen David

DELHI | Prodigal Son

After six years, the Rashtriya Lok Dal (RLD) has returned to the NDA just before the upcoming polls. According to BJP's prime ministerial candidate L.K. Advani, the tie-up aims to "end the SP and BSP rule in Uttar Pradesh." The alliance is expected to give the NDA a shot in the arm in western Uttar Pradesh. While the alliance has been made public, seat sharing is still being kept under wraps.



RAJNATH SINGH (LEFT) AND JOGI

Singh had been agriculture minister during the NDA government in 2001-03. He left after he was stripped of his portfolio. During the nuclear deal vote in Parliament, he had been rooting for BSP chief Mayawati as the prime ministerial candidate. The battle for Uttar Pradesh just got more bitter.

by Shyam Lal Yadav